RULES GOVERNING ATTENDANCE BY UNATTACHED FREEMASONS

Rule 127 of the Book of Constitutions governs the attendance at Lodge by Unattached Freemasons. Since 9th September 2020, the rule has stated:

> **127.** In the case of a Brother who has ceased to be a subscribing member of every Lodge of which he has at any time been a member, the following provisions shall have effect, viz.:
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> (i) If he comes within the provisions of this Rule by reason of his exclusion under Rule 148 or Rule 181, he shall not be permitted to attend any Lodge or Lodge of Instruction until he again becomes a subscribing member of a Lodge.
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> (ii) If he comes within the provisions of this Rule by reason of his expulsion from the Craft or by reason of his resignation from the Craft under Rule 183A or Rule 277A, his right to attend any Lodge or Lodge of Instruction shall be forfeited.
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> (iii) In any other case he shall not be permitted to attend any one Lodge more than once until he again becomes a subscribing member of a Lodge, and upon such one attendance he shall append the word 'unattached' to his signature in the attendance book, stating therein the name and number of the Lodge of which he was last a subscribing member. Notwithstanding the foregoing provisions of this paragraph he shall be permitted to attend one, but only one, Lodge on not more than two further occasions with a view to becoming a subscribing member of that Lodge; provided that (a) the Master of that Lodge shall have confirmed to the Secretary in writing that such is the purpose of his subsequent visit, and (b) his final visit to such Lodge shall take place not later than one year after the first visit.
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> Nothing in this Rule shall preclude the attendance of a Brother at any Lodge of which he is an Honorary Member.

Therefore, an Unattached Freemason who has not been excluded, expelled or resigned from the Craft, may attend any Lodge once. He may attend one Lodge up to three times if he is considering joining that Lodge and providing the three visits occur within a twelve-month period.

The rationale for this latter provision is, in the words of the President of the Board of General Purposes, RW Bro. Geoffrey Dearing, to:

> *"help him make a reasoned judgment concerning the Lodge he considers joining. Only being able to visit the Lodge on one occasion is unlikely to give a proper chance of making that judgment. The members of the Lodge, which the brother is considering joining, will wish to know something about him so that they in turn can make their own judgment on whether the individual is right for the Lodge. Even a small Lodge would have difficulty in making a decision from a single visit by the potential joining member."*
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> First Rising, 6th July 2020